

SeedHammer II — the taproot pathological wallet

The hardest wallet this constellation describes, round-tripped on the machine.

This is the four-tier degrading vault — the wallet CORPUS.md calls *the* pathological example — expressed as a **depth-3 taproot tree**:

```
tr(50929b74c1a04954b78b4b6035e97a5e078a5a0f28ec96d547bfee9ace803ac0,{and_v(v:after(1000000),and_v(v:sha256(a84dce40975727c398023cfbd50d5db3b9662375521d0f1ac62dbd829b9a08ad),multi_a(3,@0/48'/0'/0'/2'/'<0;1>/*,@1/48'/0'/1'/2'/'<0;1>/*,@2/48'/0'/2'/2'/'<0;1>/*))),{and_v(v:after(1893456000),and_v(v:sha256(a84dce40975727c398023cfbd50d5db3b9662375521d0f1ac62dbd829b9a08ad),multi_a(2,@3/48'/0'/3'/2'/'<0;1>/*,@4/48'/0'/0'/2'/'<0;1>/*,@5/48'/0'/1'/2'/'<0;1>/*))),{and_v(v:older(65535),multi_a(2,@6/48'/0'/2'/2'/'<0;1>/*,@7/48'/0'/3'/2'/'<0;1>/*)),and_v(v:older(4255898),multi_a(1,@8/48'/0'/0'/2'/'<0;1>/*,@9/48'/0'/1'/2'/'<0;1>/*,@10/48'/0'/2'/2'/'<0;1>/*))}}})
```

Two sha256 hashlocks. Both Bitcoin timelock flavours, absolute and relative. multi_a at thresholds 3, 2, 2 and 1. A **NUMS internal key**, so there is no key-path spend at all — every route to the coins goes through a script leaf. Eleven cosigners across **three masters**.

Until three commits ago this document could not exist. Every one of its four leaves is and_v(v:...) wrapping a timelock or a hashlock, and the device's tap-leaf reader named only pk / multi_a / sortedmulti_a. It returned zero leaves and the consent screen read "Complex policy — display only", while the host derived the same wallet's addresses without complaint. That was F-214; the fix replaced the vocabulary with an emitter, and this journey is the proof it worked.

The keys are BIP-39 test vectors. Never put funds behind them.

1 · Every slot's origin matches its own key file

The template carries eleven per-key origins, written by hand; the eleven key files declare them independently. If the two disagreed, the card would name a path the key does not live at — and **nothing downstream would notice**, because addresses come from the xpub a card carries, never from the origin it declares. That is F-217's lesson, and this gate is the answer to it.

```
@0 48'/0'/0'/2' ok
@1 48'/0'/1'/2' ok
@2 48'/0'/2'/2' ok
@3 48'/0'/3'/2' ok
@4 48'/0'/0'/2' ok
@5 48'/0'/1'/2' ok
@6 48'/0'/2'/2' ok
@7 48'/0'/3'/2' ok
@8 48'/0'/0'/2' ok
@9 48'/0'/1'/2' ok
@10 48'/0'/2'/2' ok

0 slot(s) disagree with their key file
```

2 · The engraved artifact

The keyless template set — 4 chunks. No --path: the origins ride in the template, and --path would flatten eleven distinct origins onto one.

And nothing would stop it.

An earlier draft of this page said `md encode "refuses outright"`. Measured: it refuses the *keyed* form, where it can see one fingerprint bound to several different keys — but on this *keyless* template --path exits **0** and produces a perfectly good card with eleven wrong origins. The check needs a fingerprint *and* an xpub per slot, and a keyless template carries neither (F-221). **The card that gets engraved is the form the guard cannot see**, so leaving --path off here is a choice this journey makes, not one the tool enforces.

```
$ /scratch/code/shibboleth/descriptor-mnemonic/target/release/md encode tr(50929b74c1a04954b78b4b6035e97a5e078a5a0f28ec96d54
7bfee9ace803ac0,{and_v(v:after(1000000),and_v(v:sha256(a84dce40975727c398023cfbd50d5db3b9662375521d0f1ac62dbd829b9a08ad),mul
ti_a(3,@0/48'/0'/0'/2'<0;1>/*,@1/48'/0'/1'/2'<0;1>/*,@2/48'/0'/2'/2'<0;1>/*)),{and_v(v:after(1893456000),and_v(v:sha256
(a84dce40975727c398023cfbd50d5db3b9662375521d0f1ac62dbd829b9a08ad),multi_a(2,@3/48'/0'/3'/2'<0;1>/*,@4/48'/0'/0'/2'<0;1>
*,@5/48'/0'/1'/2'<0;1>/*)),{and_v(v:older(65535),multi_a(2,@6/48'/0'/2'/2'<0;1>/*,@7/48'/0'/3'/2'<0;1>/*),and_v(v:older
(4255898),multi_a(1,@8/48'/0'/0'/2'<0;1>/*,@9/48'/0'/1'/2'<0;1>/*,@10/48'/0'/2'/2'<0;1>/*))}}}) --group-size 0 --force-ch
unked
chunk-set-id: 0x3d896
md1f8kykps9zjtvyyj5jmplprj5jtvyy49ykcgfw2fdsssj5jtvyyw2fdssj55jmplp9ef9kzzz2fdsturhn8pf8jq0c
md1f8kykpsgs3ef9kzz2j5qqcr32v6mqg85yszv6a4pxuusy2unu8xqz8naa2r2akwukvgm42glxskfar6x4423
md1f8kykps9zjtvyyj5jmplprj5jtvyy49ykcgfw2fdsssj5jtvyyw2fdssj55jmplp9ef9kzzz2fdsturhn8pf8jq0c
md1f8kykps9zjtvyyj5jmplprj5jtvyy49ykcgfw2fdsssj5jtvyyw2fdssj55jmplp9ef9kzzz2fdsturhn8pf8jq0c
md1f8kykpsmje3rw4fp6rc6cckmmq5mngy26gpzx3g4xdwqq8lluszze6v6uqpq0px3qq2y6qqmxcdfn702jwt
note: stdout is a keyless descriptor template (no keys)
[exit 0]
```

The engraved set is 4 md1 chunk(s).


```
0975727c398023cfbd50d5db3b9662375521d0f1ac62dbd829b9a08ad),multi_a(3,@0/<0;1>/*,@1/<0;1>/*,@2/<0;1>/*)),{and_v(v:after(1893456000),and_v(v:sha256(a84dce40975727c398023cfbd50d5db3b9662375521d0f1ac62dbd829b9a08ad),multi_a(2,@3/<0;1>/*,@4/<0;1>/*,@5/<0;1>/*)),{and_v(v:older(65535),multi_a(2,@6/<0;1>/*,@7/<0;1>/*)),and_v(v:older(4255898),multi_a(1,@8/<0;1>/*,@9/<0;1>/*,@10/<0;1>/*))}}})
```

n: 11

... clipped; full text in transcript_tr_pathological.txt

5 · What the device must prove to

Derived from the *cards*, not from the argument list that made them.

```
wallet idwallet-policy-id: 590f3abcaad2aca5a3f526917f5bb57a
receive 0..1bc1pgavpejq7pkax6zdtuay9ejenangza2t3l6gfka79h94p23xcexssak7pzzr
bc1p3wy7tcypvkm49wtyeq2yw4t0266vxdnq1kny5nsgzguc0fcvd13s5hkkp5
change 0..1bc1pnjrzcky5qq1hyz4rvhq5r96ca77wyccnfls0p517k8ae7402vjhshf3zya
bc1p7yrpv9q6j58vvh5yrnnj8ky6dnykn7z2lak4j0ckt52j84j8fxzs4h6khc
```

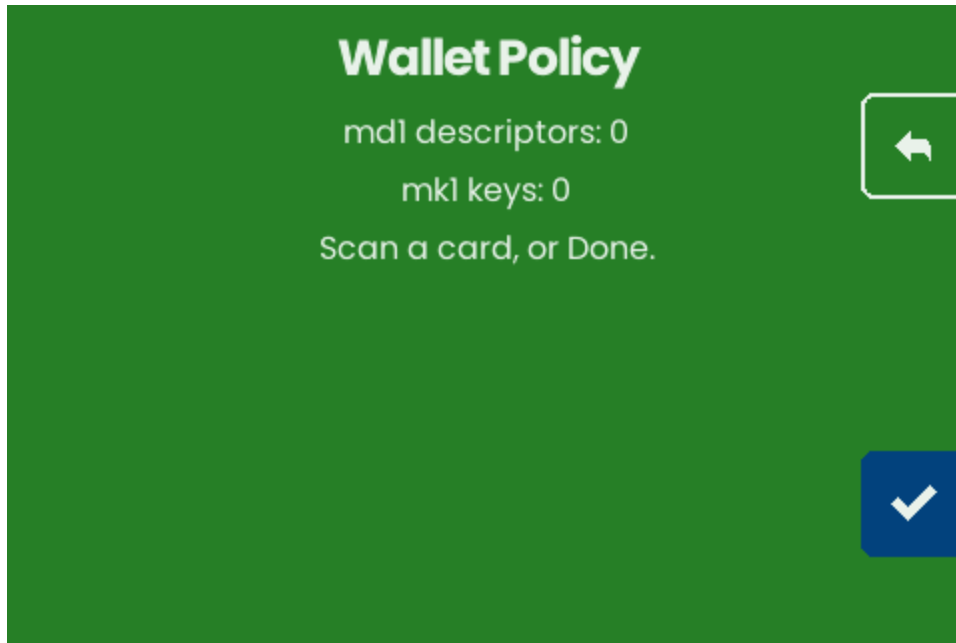
6 · The device



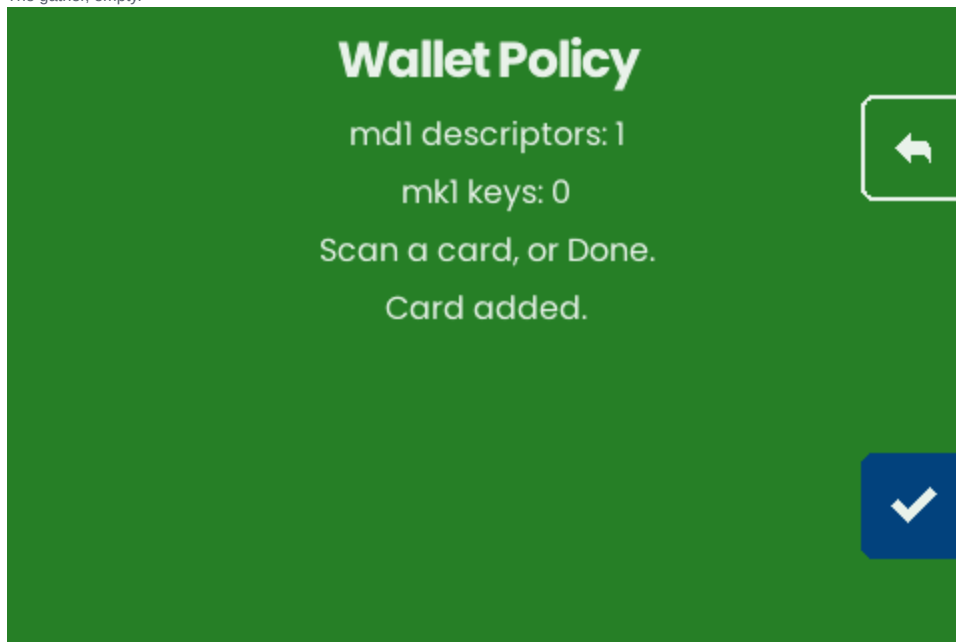
Home.



Wallet Policy.



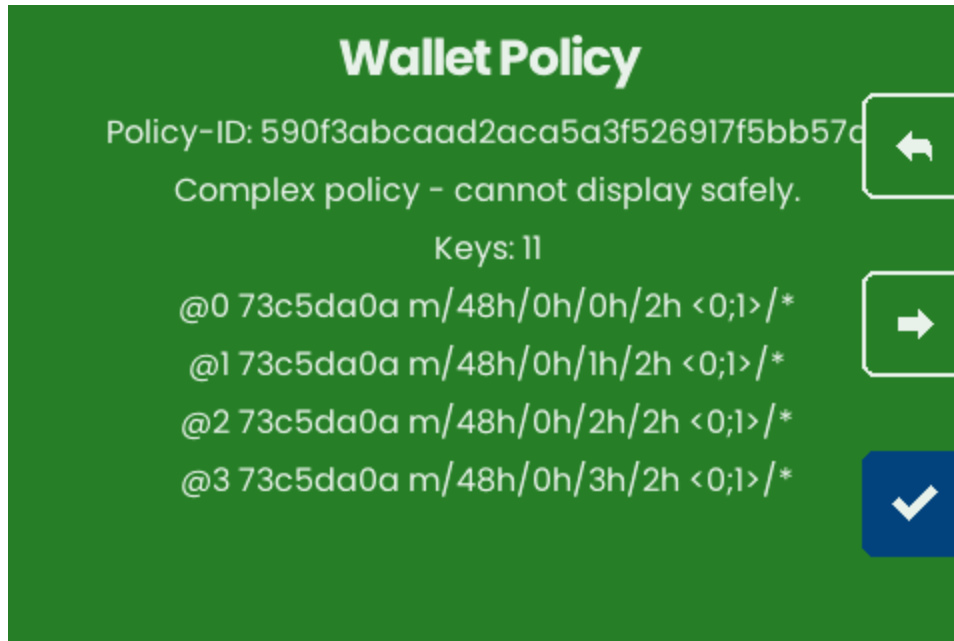
The gather, empty.



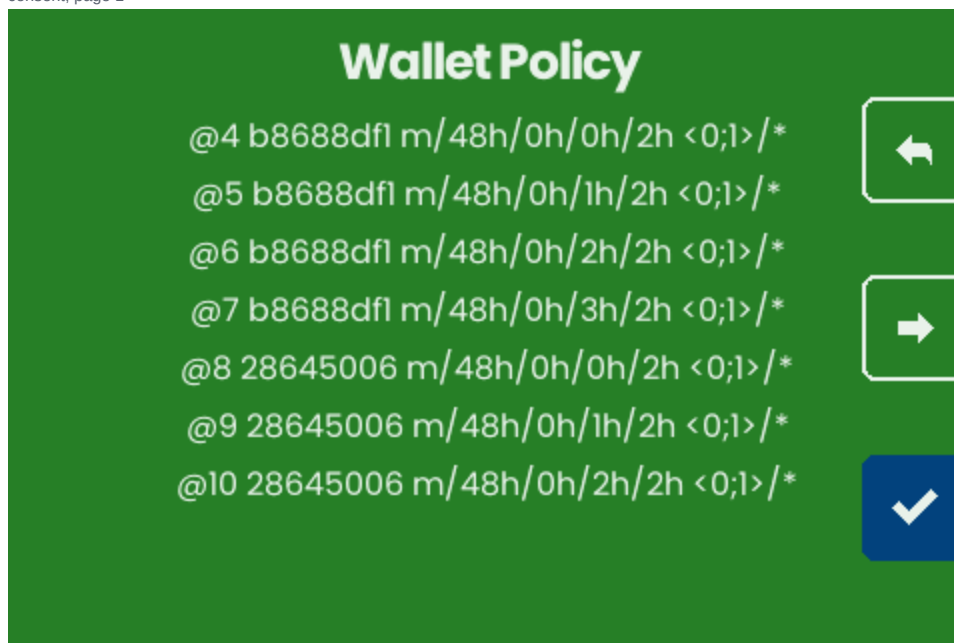
After all 24 chunks cross the reader: ONE card.

7 · The proof, on the consent path

Eleven key slots print before the addresses do, so the screen pages 4 times — and the walk reads every page, because a bound tuned for a four-key wallet would stop before reaching the half that matters.



consent, page 1



consent, page 2

Wallet Policy

Receive 0:

bc1pgavpejq7pkax6zdtuay9ejenangza2t3l6gfka79h94p23
xcexssak7p2r



Receive 1:

bc1p3wy7tcypvkm49wtieq2yw4t0266vxdnqlkny5nsgzguc
0fcvdl3s5hkkp5



Change 0:



consent, page 3

Wallet Policy

bc1pnjrzc ky5qqlhyz4rvhq5r96ca77wyccnfls0p5l7k8ad
vjhshf3zya



Change 1:

bc1p7yrpv9q6j58vwh5yrnnj8ky6dnykn7z2lak4j0ckt52
xzs4h6khc



consent, page 4

8 · What this run established

The capture is a **comparison**. It is handed the host's id and addresses and throws if the screen disagrees, and the absence assertions reject "display only" and "no addresses" outright — so the device cannot pass by refusing politely.

```
chunks presented24
cards gathered1
consent pages read4
wallet id matched590f3abcaad2aca5a3f526917f5bb57a
addresses matchedbc1pgavpejq7pkax6zdtuay9ejenangza2t3l6gfka79h94p23xcexsak7p2r
bc1p3wy7tcypvkm49wtieq2yw4t0266vxdnqlkny5nsgzguc0fcvd13s5hkkp5
bc1pnjrzc5qqlhyz4rvhq5r96ca77wyccnfls0p517k8ae7402vjhshf3zya
bc1p7yrpv9q6j58vwh5yrnnj8ky6dnykn7z2lak4j0ckt52j84j8fxzs4h6khc
```

The negative control is a command, not a memory. `python3 capture_tr_pathological.py --prove-it-can-fail` corrupts one character of one expected address and exits 0 only if the walk *caught* it. A comparison nobody has made fail is not evidence that it can.

Reproducing

```
bash transcript_tr_pathological.sh > transcript_tr_pathological.txt 2>&1
python3 capture_tr_pathological.py                # rebuilds emu.wasm, drives it
python3 capture_tr_pathological.py --prove-it-can-fail # the negative control
python3 build_pdf_tr_pathological.py              # this document
```

What this journey does NOT show

- **No spend, and for tiers 1–2 no spend is possible from this backup at all.** Both hashlock tiers need the 32-byte preimage to spend, and zero backup strings carry it (F-132).
- **The tiers do not degrade in the order they read.** Tier 4 (1-of-3) matures at 365 days; tier 3 (2-of-2) at ~455 — the weakest key-set unlocks ~90 days *first* (F-133).
- **No plate read-back.** There is no reader; the card-set equality above is the honest proxy.
- **No ms1 secret leg.** Taproot-independent, and already shown in the earlier journeys.
- **Decode's output still does not round-trip** (F-219). The card carries its origins and both `md inspect` and `md decode` now report them — an earlier draft of this line said neither did, which its own section 4 already disproved. What remains is that decode's *stdout* renders them away, so re-encoding what it prints yields a different card.